In a way, such a performance contrasts with the Bangladeshi security forces' actions in other places, for example at the Indian borders where they are occasionally seen to retaliate against provocation by the Border Security Force (BSF) of India.[14] In recent years, however, the Dhaka government has employed excessive controls along the Myanmar border, partly to keep Rohingya infiltration to a minimum (IRIN 2015). But while there are the usual concerns regarding the possibility of mass infiltration, decisions are occasionally made to serve intricate political equations as well. It is alleged that the huge deployment of Bangladeshi troops along the Myanmar borders in 2008 — although reportedly in response to unilateral oil exploration attempts and excessive military movement by Myanmar — may have been partly initiated out of political calculations by the then-caretaker government. Nonetheless a lack of field data and analysis causes speculation about decisions by the paramilitary command or even the political leadership concerning the bordering region from time to time (Sen 2014).

A degree of over-assessment of threat has also prevented humanitarian responses from the Bangladeshi border guards in dealing with refugees. Back in 2008 (during the border crisis with Myanmar) or even in 2012, when the Rohingya were victims of massive oppression in Rakhine State, the Bangladeshi border guards were involved in 'pushing-back' any refuge-seeking Rohingya who happened to reach the west coast — many of whom were hapless women and children. On 11 June 2012 alone, the Border Guards Bangladesh (BGB) sent away eleven boats carrying around 500 Rohingya as they tried to enter Bangladesh through Teknaf via the River Naaf (Barua 2012). Such arbitrary 'push-back' incidents in many cases risked the asylum-seekers' lives and possessions.

Also, the Bangladesh government is increasingly assertive in its own territorial control in the hilly regions and hinterlands along the border. Between February and July 2015, there were a number of military and paramilitary operations inside Bangladesh (in areas west of the Arakan Yoma) to weed out possible miscreants or insurgent hideouts. According to the deputy director general of the BGB, the Bangladeshi government and border forces were not to "allow any separatist forces to establish their bases within Bangladesh" (UNB 2015) (Map 16.1 shows the combing operation areas).